EL SALVADOR* (1 October)

Harvesting of the 2004/05 main first season maize crop has been completed and, despite some crop losses in the eastern departments, following a dry spell in August, production prospects are above average. Normal to abundant rains in the past few weeks benefited the start of plantings of the second season 'de postrera' maize and bean crops.

Food assistance continues to be delivered by the international community, targeting in particular children living in the rural and urban areas of the country's most food insecure departments like Ahuachapán, Chalatenango, Cabañas and Morazán.

